PassFrame
TUITION

The Night Train

Year 4 — 11+ Homework Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Comprehension | Poetry

Extract (poem) — read it carefully before answering

The night train rattles down the track,
clickety-clack, clickety-clack,
past sleeping towns and fields of wheat,
a rhythm steady as a heartbeat.

I press my face against the glass
and watch the dark world slowly pass:
a farmhouse light, a distant spire,
a lonely chimney's curling fire.

The carriage hums a gentle song,
the journey far, the night is long,
and other travellers, half-asleep,
let silence settle soft and deep.

I wonder where the others go,
what stories ride this train, below
the rattling wheels, the swaying light —
a thousand journeys, one shared night.

At last my eyelids start to close,
the clickety-clack becomes a doze,
and somewhere past the edge of sleep,
the night train rattles on, and keeps.

Questions

25 min · 12 questions

1. What is passing by outside the train, according to the first verse?

2. What does the poet do with their face in the second verse?

3. Underline the line that tells you other travellers were falling asleep.

4. Underline the rhyming pair of words in the final verse.

5. What does the phrase “swaying light” suggest about conditions inside the train?

6. Put these events in order: the poet falls asleep / the poet watches the dark world pass / the train rattles down the track / the poet wonders about the other travellers.

7. Why might the poet have compared the train's rhythm to a heartbeat?

8. What three things does the poet see through the window in verse two?

9. Why do you think the poet describes the night as “long” in the third verse?

10. What does the final verse suggest happens to the poet as the poem ends?

11. Find and copy a word from the poem that means “a short, light sleep”.

12. Write one or two sentences imagining where you think the night train might be heading, using clues from the poem.